"All the News That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, partly cloudy, dry, breezy, high 65. **Tonight,** partly cloudy, dry, breezy, low 48. **Tomorrow,** partly sunny, dry, occasionally breezy, high 61. Weather map is on Page B12.

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NEWS ANALYSIS

French Right Has Opening In Upheaval

Riots Fit Rhetoric as Election Approaches

By CATHERINE PORTER

PARIS — After riots erupted this weekend in cities across France, its centrist government blamed the main far-left party, accusing its politicians of inciting the violence. That party blamed the government, accusing it of stirring public anger through years of bad governance and heavy-handed policing.

What did the main far-right party do? It blamed both, and launched into campaign mode.

"We are paying for decades of being soft on crime, of weak authority, of the moral, psychological, and material disarmament of our internal security forces," Jordan Bardella, the president of the far-right National Rally party, said after emerging from a police station in central Paris on Sunday. He said he had gone there to support police officers.



THIBAUD MORITZ/AFP — GETTY IMAGES

Student protests have widened into a national movement.

Then he addressed France's "honest citizens" who were stunned on Sunday by the smashed storefronts and burned-out businesses destroyed by rioters the night before. He said they had a vital role to play in reinstating national stability. And that would be by voting in the coming election for his party.

"People need to wake up now," Mr. Bardella said. "They need to make the right political choices, and in any case, we stand ready to restore order in the country."

Sunday was a day of mourning, shock and finger pointing in France. The day before, huge peaceful protests for better school conditions and against rising living costs were overshadowed by black-clad and often masked agitators of unclear affiliation who attacked government buildings and shops across the country, sometimes stealing wine or electronics.

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G.O.P. in Ohio Shifts Message In Senate Race

Talk of Socialist Threat in Bid to Lift Turnout

By EMILY DAVIES

Just two volunteers showed up on a recent weekday at a Republican Party campaign office near Cleveland that in 2024 was brimming with activity every night.

One of the two, Tanya Karabanovs, 54, sat among stacks of untouched yard signs and brainstormed new ways to convince her neighbors to vote for Republican candidates such as Senator Jon Husted, who was appointed in 2025 to finish the term of Vice President JD Vance. Her most recent idea: stuffing chocolate bars into goody bags with leftover campaign literature.

"This is really a weird cycle," said Ms. Karabanovs, who recalled at least 30 volunteers packing into the office each day in 2024. "There's no way to feel confident about any of the races, honestly."

Many of the Republican volunteers trying to keep Ohio's Senate seat red started the summer making the case that, despite rising prices, Mr. Husted was better suited to fix the economy than his Democratic challenger, the former senator Sherrod Brown. But when it became clear that the message wasn't landing, they began to pivot.

Some, like Ms. Karabanovs, got creative. The political PAC for Americans for Prosperity, a prominent conservative advocacy group that deploys thousands of door-knockers across the state, switched its script to the threat of socialism — and organizers quickly noticed a difference.

"I wouldn't like that," said Nikki Cvetkovic, 77, after opening her door in a working-class suburb of Youngstown and inspecting a pamphlet with a picture of Brown next to the words, "SOCIALISM THREATENS YOUR FREEDOM." She said she would cast her ballot for Mr. Husted.

Polls have shown Mr. Brown running ahead of Mr. Husted in one of the most closely watched races of this cycle. But many conservatives across the state believe they can pull off in the final two weeks what Republicans have done better than Democrats for the last 10 years: defy expectations on Election Day.

The modern-day Republican Party is built on upsets. Twice, polls showed Mr. Trump losing the presidential election only for him to triumph, cementing the MAGA movement's staying power and underdog status. The question now is whether the G.O.P. can do it again, at a time when Mr. Trump is not on the ballot and his popularity is historically low.

The answer lies on the ground in unexpected battlegrounds, in-

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ERIN SCHAFF/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Daryl Mason and Genia Weitz slept in the living room to save on electricity, which they need to run their CPAP and oxygen machines.

Americans Staggering as Their Power Bills Skyrocket

In Oklahoma, a Record-Hot Summer Exposed an Affordability Crisis

By ELI SASLOW

McALESTER, Okla. — The worst of the heat was just beginning to lift when Genia Weitz, 58, walked into the stubborn Oklahoma sun last month and found the next emergency waiting in her mailbox. "Disconnection notice," the letter began. She scanned her electric bill and saw a total balance of $1,340.96, far more than her monthly income. State rules prevented the power company from shutting off someone's electricity when the heat index was above 101 degrees, but now it had dropped to 99, and Weitz had nine days to pay.

She went back inside, where the window shades were drawn and heavy blankets hung across the halls and doorways to trap cool air. The house had three bedrooms and two bathrooms, but for the past several months Weitz and her husband, Daryl Mason, had mostly confined themselves to their 300-square-foot living room, letting the rest of the house bake to save money on electricity. They had an air-conditioner mounted to the window that rattled all day. They had her oxygen machine plugged into the wall and his CPAP machine for sleep apnea hooked up in the corner.

Weitz had been sleeping on the couch while Mason slept in the recliner. Sometimes, their grandchildren would pile onto mattresses. On the most humid nights, the heat index outside barely dropped below 85, and their machines ran until morning.

"I can't breathe if I don't have my oxygen," Weitz said, as she handed the bill to Mason. "I don't think I'd last a single night."

"We'd probably stroke out anyway in all this heat," Mason said. "If we lose this room, we're not going to make it."

As fall sets in across the country, the bill is coming due for the hottest summer on record in the United States. The last three months were about three degrees above average, hotter than the

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MIKE KAI CHEN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Dederek Huff's skills during California's election season mirrored those he once used to sell drugs.

These Autograph Collectors Really Want Yours

A Lucrative Scramble to Place Measures on the Ballot

By LAUREL ROSENHALL

SAN FRANCISCO — Dederek Huff scanned the grassy hillside of Dolores Park in San Francisco one day this spring and saw dozens of people relaxing on picnic blankets and park benches.

To most people, it was an idyllic scene on a sunny day. To Mr. Huff, however, it was an opportunity to earn as much as $125 from each person in the park who would sign the stack of petitions under his arm.

"How y'all doing?" Mr. Huff asked as he approached a group of friends on a blanket. "Are you registered to vote?"

With his ease talking to strangers and his knack for reading a crowd, Mr. Huff used the same skills he said he had developed in a very different setting: selling party drugs on the Las Vegas Strip.

He had come to San Francisco because word had spread that campaigns were paying big money to place measures on the November ballot. So much, in fact, that Mr. Huff said he found he could make more money dealing democracy than dope.

"This is better than drug money," said Mr. Huff, who has had drug-related arrests in Nevada, records show.

Mr. Huff was part of a small army of petition circulators who fanned out to shopping centers and street corners this spring, becoming the main reason that the ballots sent to California voters this month are stuffed with statewide initiatives.

California's direct democracy system began over a century ago

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Successful Pact In Climate Fight Offers a Model

By CHICO HARLAN

Over the past decade, the nations of the world have struggled to aggressively fight global warming. With a notable exception.

In 2016, more than 170 countries agreed to phase out hydrofluorocarbons, super-polluting chemicals widely used in air-conditioners and refrigerators. Known as HFCs, they are an extremely potent greenhouse gas and trap much more heat than carbon dioxide.

Ten years later, it's clear that the agreement is succeeding. And it offers a template for how other climate regulations might work despite political backlash to green policymaking, experts say.

The HFC deal has "worked perfectly," said Paul Bledsoe, who worked on climate issues under President Bill Clinton, and helped push for the HFC pact, known as the Kigali Amendment. "It reduces temperatures fast at an incredibly low cost."

Countries are ahead of their target to cut production and use of HFCs. Chemical companies support the deal and are rolling out alternatives. The United Nations says the accord is projected to prevent 0.5 degrees Celsius of warming, or 0.9 degrees Fahrenheit, by the end of the century.

Under the Paris Agreement, the 2015 international climate deal to fight climate change, the world has sought to limit warming to 1.5 degrees Celsius above preindustrial times, though that is looking increasingly unlikely.

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Trump Officials Had Fed Fears Of Carnage of Bomb in Space

By WILLIAM J. BROAD

In his first term, President Trump signed an executive order directing federal agencies to defend the United States against an unusual type of nuclear strike that his advisers warned could shatter the power grid, wipe out critical infrastructure and lead to a national collapse.

Such an attack, caused by the detonation of a nuclear warhead miles above the earth, would not have the power to kill people directly. Instead, it could create an enormous surge of energy, known as an electromagnetic pulse or EMP, able to fry anything electrical on the ground below. Detonated at the right height and location — say, 250 miles above Omaha — the impact might zap the computers of every modern car and airplane, trash the nation's food supply, short out all telecommunications, do in the banking system and plunge the country into indeterminate darkness.

For more than a decade, a movement — largely among conservatives — raised awareness of such a threat, culminating in Mr. Trump's 2019 executive order. Many of the movement's most ardent voices are now members of the current administration, including Pete Hegseth, the defense secretary; JD Vance, the vice president; John Ratcliffe, the C.I.A. director; and Mike Huckabee, the U.S. ambassador to Israel.

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Once a model of economic stability, the country now faces hardship as its policies shake investor confidence. PAGE B1

China Exports Fuel Its Growth
A housing crash, slow consumer spending and plunging investment have left its economy propped by trade. PAGE B1

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A safe reputation in the Emirates was shaken by what the authorities said was a plot last month aimed at crashing a flight from Dubai to Tel Aviv. PAGE A7

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Facing soaring costs and cuts to federal benefits, many people run out of money well before the month ends. PAGE A10

The Making of an ICE Target
How a Dominican man's turbulent life culminated in a violent encounter with federal agents in New York. PAGE A16



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Throwing hammers, lifting stones and arm wrestling are some ways people get strong around the world. PAGE D7

Filling In the Gaps in Stuttering
A condition that has received scant medical attention may benefit from updated treatment options. PAGE D5

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A Knick Has the Last Laugh
For years, Karl-Anthony Towns heard he was too soft to win. Now an N.B.A. champion, he's savoring the vindication and appreciating the journey. PAGE B7

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Visionary in the Art World
Peter Nagy, 66, moved from New York City, where he co-founded an early artist-run gallery, and highlighted the works of his new home, India.

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Jeffrey Toobin PAGE A20



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Is It Painting or Sculpture?
Torkwase Dyson plays havoc with the distinction between art in two dimensions or three, priming us to look at surfaces in a particular way. PAGE C1